The 6:15

TUESDAY · OCTOBER 27, 2026 NO. 31

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Tue 10/27 (today)	FOMC meeting begins; durable goods, housing starts/permits, consumer confidence, 8:30–10:00a ET **(consensus not verified this run)**; World Series Gm. 4, Brewers at Rays, Tropicana Field, 8p ET — MIL leads 3-0, can clinch.
Wed 10/28	FOMC rate decision 2:00p ET, Powell 2:30p; target 3.50–3.75% unchanged since June 17; cut odds ~15–23% (Manifold) **(CME FedWatch unreachable this run)**. MSFT, GOOGL report Q3 after close **(consensus not verified this run)**.
Thu 10/29	Q3 GDP advance est. (BEA) & jobless claims, 8:30a ET; AMZN reports after close. Sept. PCE also expected this week **(exact date not reconfirmed this run)**.
Sat 11/1	OPEC+ meets.
Tue 11/3	Midterm elections — House and Senate majorities both in play.

Meta already reported (Oct. 21, per secondary trackers; not independently verified this run). No confirmed frontier AI release or major rocket launch this week — omitted rather than padded.

METRICS · ~6:15A ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	$116.00 (+0.16%) / $102.04 (+0.28%) — oilprice.com, ~11-min delay; both just under Fri. settles ($116.72/$103.27). Spread ~$13.96.
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	4.68% / 5.00% / 5.31% — Treasury.gov, Mon. 10/26 official close.
DXY	102.24 (+0.28%) — Yahoo Finance, 6:07a ET.
S&P / Nasdaq-100 / Dow futures	7,713.25 (-0.02%) / 29,431.50 (-0.02%) / 52,586 (+0.07%) — premarket, ~6a ET.

VIX	18.25 (-0.76%), 6:02a ET — down from Fri.'s 19.45 close.
Gold	$3,995.10 (-0.53%) — Kitco, 6:16a ET; back under $4,000.
Mon. 10/26 close	Dow 52,361.58 (+0.28%); S&P 7,676.77 (+0.70%); Nasdaq Comp. 26,169.38 (+0.82%) **[NEW]**
Retail gas (AAA natl. avg.)	$4.2661/gal (10/27), down from Fri.'s $4.2957 — snaps a 3-day rise **[NEW]**
Asia / Europe closes	**Not confirmed as of press time.**

S&P and Nasdaq both closed Monday above Thursday's pre-selloff levels — a full recovery of Friday's rout and then some; the Dow recovered only ~22% of its 652-point Friday drop. See Lead.

HORMUZ COUNTERS — STRAITS.LIVE, 27 OCT 10:13Z (6:13A ET)

Transits	4 vessels/day (~5% of 85/day baseline) — Oct. 18 IMF PortWatch reading, now 9 days stale.
Dark tankers, 24h	160/226 screened (70.8%) vs. 7-day avg. 96.0 — flat vs. Fri.'s 72.0%/180-of-250.
War-risk premium	~32.0x pre-crisis — Oct. 7 estimate, 20 days stale; background only.
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±12 (Extreme, band widened from ±8 Sat.); Escalation Forecast 61±11 (High, flat).
Closure status	Day 240 per straits.live's transit framing. Iran's armed forces chief claimed full closure Tue. 07:09Z (Mehr/state media) **[DEVELOPING, uncorroborated]**
Strikes, 24h (claimed)	11:58Z Sirik explosion amid claimed missile fire (WANA, single-sourced) **[NEW]**; 18:46Z gCaptain: tanker disabled, second vessel afire, attacker unidentified **[NEW]**. See Iran & Hormuz.

IRGC/state-media claims (no independent corroboration), UKMTO (no matching advisory this period), PortWatch (lagged AIS transit count) and straits.live's AIS dark-tanker screen (sensitive to ambient dropout) measure different things over different windows — never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over (eliminated Oct. 7).
Knicks	No reported trades or signings in the last 24 hours.
Northwestern	No reported moves.

LEAD

MARKETS / FED WEEK

Stocks erase Friday's rout and then some, oil holds near its highs, as fresh Hormuz claims land without a flinch — now comes the Fed and Big Tech

Monday's session did something Friday's didn't: it shrugged off the Strait of Hormuz. Two fresh, uncorroborated incident reports landed squarely in market hours — an explosion near Sirik amid claimed anti-ship missile fire at 11:58Z (7:58a ET), and a gCaptain report of a tanker disabled and a second vessel afire in the Persian Gulf at 18:46Z (2:46p ET) — and equities kept climbing through both. The Dow added 146.42 points (+0.28%) to 52,361.58; the S&P 500 jumped 53.09 (+0.70%) to 7,676.77; the Nasdaq Composite rose 214.04 (+0.82%) to 26,169.38. [fact, NEW] The S&P and Nasdaq didn't just recover Friday's losses — both closed above Thursday's pre-selloff levels, meaning Monday's rally more than erased the damage this brief described in issue No. 30. The Dow didn't: its gain clawed back only about 22% of Friday's 652-point drop, the weakest of the three. [fact/read, NEW]

That split is a tell. The S&P and Nasdaq carry more weight in the mega-cap tech names reporting this week — Microsoft and Alphabet after Wednesday's close, Amazon after Thursday's — while the Dow holds more of the oil-sensitive industrials and transports still facing a Brent benchmark stuck near $116. [read] Oil itself barely moved on the fresh strike claims: Brent trades at $116.00 and WTI at $102.04 this morning, both a shade under Friday's settles ($116.72/$103.27) rather than above them. [fact, NEW] If Monday's reports had been priced as credible escalation, the textbook reaction — a fresh leg up

in crude — didn't happen. Read: traders appear to be discounting Iranian strike claims by default, after a cadence of IRGC assertions this month — an Oct. 17 two-supertanker mine claim that the JMIC said had "no substantiation," an Oct. 20 claim of two more mined tankers, an Oct. 24 claim of two disabled supertankers — that UKMTO, CENTCOM and independent monitors have repeatedly failed to corroborate. [read]

That skepticism now has one more data point to weigh against. Iran's armed forces chief said early Tuesday (07:09Z) that the strait is "completely closed," per Mehr and other state media — a claim with no independent verification, and one CENTCOM has called false before. [fact, NEW] Meanwhile straits.live's dark-tanker screen, which jumped sharply Friday, has essentially plateaued rather than accelerated: 70.8% of screened tankers ran dark in the past 24 hours versus Friday's 72.0%, both well above the 96.0 seven-day average. [fact, DEVELOPING]

Into this sits a stacked calendar. The Fed's two-day meeting starts today, with a rate decision at 2p ET Wednesday; the funds target has sat at 3.50%–3.75% since the June 17 cut, and prediction markets put the odds of a cut this week at roughly 15%–23% — thin, and not cross-checked against CME FedWatch, whose site returned a server error to this brief this morning. [fact/flag, NEW] A hold looks like the base case. The mechanism to watch: if the Fed holds while Brent sits near a seven-month high, that's an energy-driven inflation pulse arriving just as the central bank is already reluctant to ease — a cross-current Chair Powell will have to address at Wednesday's press conference regardless of what the committee decides. [read]

Big Tech earnings compound the stakes. Microsoft and Alphabet report Wednesday after the close, Amazon Thursday after the close —

all three landing within about a day of the Fed decision. [fact, NEW] Consensus estimates for the quarter aren't cleanly verifiable this run: public trackers show conflicting figures depending on whether they're citing the calendar or fiscal quarter, so this brief isn't printing a number it can't stand behind. The second-order read: Monday's tech-led bounce is a bet that stays unsettled until Wednesday and Thursday's reports land; a miss from either Microsoft or Alphabet, arriving hours after a Fed that's already signaling caution, would hit a market with very little room already priced for disappointment. [read] Watch: 2p ET Wednesday for the Fed statement, after-hours Wednesday and Thursday for the Big Tech prints, and whether this morning's calm in oil and futures holds through the sequence or breaks.

ECONOMICS

Away from the market mechanics above: today also brings durable goods orders, housing starts and permits, and the Conference Board's consumer confidence index, all due between 8:30 and 10:00a ET; this brief could not verify consensus forecasts for any of the three this run, so none is printed. Thursday brings the Commerce Department's advance Q3 GDP estimate and the weekly jobless claims report, both at 8:30a ET. A September PCE price index release is also expected this week per prior tracking, but its exact date could not be reconfirmed this run — treat it as pending, not assumed for Thursday. No evidence surfaced this run of a federal funding lapse affecting the BLS/BEA release calendar, unlike the shutdown-driven delays that hit the October 2025 and January 2026 jobs reports; absent other information, this week's prints are assumed to proceed on schedule. [flag]

BUSINESS

Beyond the earnings-week mechanics in the Lead: Meta already reported Q3 results on Oct. 21, per secondary trackers — this brief did not independently verify that print and flags it as background only. Public earnings trackers show conflicting consensus figures for Alphabet's September-quarter EPS, clustering loosely near $3.00 but varying by source and by whether the fiscal or calendar quarter is cited; no reliable calendar-Q3 figure surfaced for Microsoft. Neither is printed here as a hard number. [flag] Separately, AAA's national average gas price slipped to $4.2661/gal Tuesday, down from Friday's $4.2957 and snapping three straight days of increases — the first retreat even as Brent and WTI hold near their highs, a gap worth watching for whether it's a genuine turn or simple retail-price lag behind last week's crude move. [fact, NEW]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the fresh strike claims covered in the Lead, the underlying counters moved little. IMF PortWatch's transit count is still stuck at 4 vessels/day against an 85/day baseline, a reading now 9 days stale without an update — the longest gap this brief has tracked since the methodology note was added. The VLCC war-risk premium, near 32x pre-crisis, is now 20 days old as an estimate and carried as background color only. straits.live's composite indices were little changed: Crisis Pressure holds at 88 (Extreme), though its error band widened to ±12 from Saturday's ±8; the Escalation Forecast is flat at 61 (High). [fact, continuity]

The pattern of disputed claims is itself the story this week. An Oct. 17 IRGC claim that two supertankers struck mines was met by a JMIC advisory the next day stating there was "no substantiation" to it; UKMTO's own account of that period described a rocket-propelled-grenade strike and an unidentified-projectile strike, not mines. An Oct. 20 claim (two more tankers, mines) and an Oct. 24 claim (two supertankers disabled by mines) followed the same arc — asserted by Iranian state channels, never corroborated by UKMTO, a flag state, or an insurer. Monday and Tuesday's claims — the Sirik explosion, the disabled tanker, and now a flat assertion of total closure — sit on top of that unresolved run, with President Trump's dismissal of the Oct. 23 seven-vessel claim as fabricated still unanswered by either government. [fact, continuity]

Diplomatically, nothing has moved since Foreign Minister Araghchi's Oct. 18 restatement that Iran's seven-day reopening plan — lifting the US naval blockade and sanctions on Iranian oil exports, and ending hostilities on all regional fronts — remains on the

table and under review in Washington. Parliament speaker Ghalibaf has said the strait stays shut until all seven conditions, based on the Islamabad memorandum, are met. [fact, continuity] OPEC+ meets Saturday, Nov. 1 — its first gathering since this week's escalation claims; no delegate has commented publicly on them. [fact]

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay in the ALDS.
Knicks	0-3; lost 111-102 at home to Orlando Sun. (Magic scored 40 in the 4th; Brunson 28, Towns 22/14 reb, Anunoby 22).
Northwestern	6-1 (3-1 Big Ten); beat Rutgers 42-14 Sat. at Ryan Field, a 4th straight win (Chiles: 3 pass TD, 2 rush TD).
World Series	Brewers lead 3-0 after a 10-1 Game 3 win Mon. at Tropicana Field (8-run 5th inning, 7 straight two-out hits — a WS record); Game 4 tonight, 8p ET, Tampa — Rays face elimination.

Continuity. Politics, Geopolitics (Russia–Ukraine) and Technology are cut this issue — no net-new, verifiable movement found this run: Reuters/Ipsos approval unchanged since the Oct. 19–20 reading already carried; no dated Ukraine development past the single-sourced Oct. 11 energy-truce claim; no confirmed frontier AI release or major rocket launch this week.

Unverified figures flagged this issue: CME FedWatch odds (site unreachable; Manifold cited instead); Microsoft/Alphabet Q3 consensus EPS (conflicting trackers); the Sept. PCE release date; Asia/Europe closes; Iran's "completely closed" claim and the Oct. 26 Sirik/tanker-disabled reports (all single- or state-media-sourced, uncorroborated). Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.